Edmar Barros

Staff Software Engineer

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Staff Software Engineer with 10+ years building and operating production-grade distributed systems, most recently building AI-driven growth tooling. I tie engineering work to business outcomes: opened a self-serve revenue stream with Stripe subscriptions, improved an unbalanced Elasticsearch cluster to cut its cost by 41%, halved new-engineer ramp-up time and reduced customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day. Specialized in backend architecture (lef a monolith-to-microservices migration), cloud infrastructure (GCP, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes), CI/CD and data platforms (PostgreSQL, Kafka, Elasticsearch, BigQuery).

"The mind that opens to a new idea never returns to its original size." - Albert Einstein

Experience

Vocational

May 2026 - Oct 2026 **Senior Software Engineer**, *Quander (Accel)*, Remote.

Maker of Hypesonic, an AI growth platform that runs marketing and distribution continuously: testing creative, targeting audiences and optimizing ad spend without human bottlenecks.

Achievements:

- **Observable agent that keeps its context:** Added Langfuse tracing and prompt management for the in-product Sonic agent, and made its sessions recover after a reboot and rehydrate on cold start.
- **Tools and a sourcing agent:** Gave the agent tools for Meta performance data and live TikTok ad search, and built a background agent that fills a global ad library, with media analyzed by Gemini.
- **LLM-written reports:** Built LLM narration for the weekly performance report, with a provider abstraction and a validator.
- **Self-serve revenue:** Built Stripe subscriptions, a paywall and credit top-ups, with agent token use priced and debited atomically. Before this, B2B customers were billed manually.
- **Meta sync and ad publishing:** Rebuilt the Meta ad sync around a per-ad model that cut API cost about 25x, and built the Meta Ad Launcher for batch publishing, plus the TikTok connection and ad sync.
- **Observability and video:** Built a shared logger, an OpenTelemetry bootstrap and a shared PostHog package, and the video editor engine with Whisper transcription.
- **Closing the loop with users:** Joined beta tester calls and onboarding walkthroughs to see where users struggled, and joined twice-weekly calls with an agency using the platform, turning its feedback into fixes and features.

Key Technologies: TypeScript, Node.js, Next.js, LLM APIs & AI agents, LangGraph, Langfuse, OpenTelemetry, PostgreSQL, BullMQ, Docker, Stripe, Meta Marketing API, TikTok Ads API, PostHog

May 2024 - May 2026 **Staff Software Engineer & Solutions Architect**, *Vendoo (YC W22)*, Remote.

Multichannel listing tool and inventory management software for online sellers, processing 90k+ daily listings across distributed services.

Achievements:

- **Cut Elasticsearch spend by 41%:** Rebuilt an unbalanced Elasticsearch cluster (oversized shards, outdated version, no index lifecycle policies) and documented a roadmap for further savings.
- **Scaled to 90k+ daily listings:** Led the migration from a Node.js monolith to event-driven microservices on Kafka, reducing listing latency by 300ms and cutting failed marketplace syncs.
- **Halved new-engineer ramp-up:** Launched internal Tech Talks (10+ sessions) and a structured 1:1 mentorship framework.
- **Faster, lighter releases:** Re-engineered build and deployment pipelines, shrinking Docker images by 70%.
- **Infrastructure ownership:** Owned GCP/Kubernetes via Terraform and Helm, and built the observability stack that caught bottlenecks before they reached users.
- **Learning from users directly:** Joined customer success calls to understand user issues, then collected metrics and logs in real time to diagnose and fix them.

Key Technologies: React, Node.js, TypeScript, Kafka, PostgreSQL, GCP, BigQuery, Elasticsearch, Terraform, Kubernetes, Helm, CircleCI, GitHub Actions

Jun. 2023 - Apr. 2024 **Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead**, *Vendoo (YC W22)*, Remote.

Achievements:

- **Found the cause of low signup rates:** Found that referral campaigns sent users to a signup page with no information about Vendoo. The growth team's A/B test confirmed a custom landing page converted better.
- **Fixed subscription billing integrity:** Fixed a bug that kept 1% of paying users marked as active after they had cancelled.
- **Led a team of up to 5 engineers:** Designed, built and shipped backend services end-to-end, owned releases and CI/CD, and aligned technical decisions with product and business goals.

Jul. 2022 - May 2023 **Senior Software Engineer**, *Paerpay (Techstars)*, Remote.

Mobile payment integration platform for the restaurant industry.

Achievements:

- **Cut partner support tickets by 30%+:** Built a real-time transaction monitoring pipeline on BigQuery, giving partners instant visibility into payment statuses.
- **Onboarded national restaurant chains:** Designed adapters for multiple SOAP-based POS systems and REST payment gateways.
- **Sub-second payments at peak:** Scaled backend services on Firebase and GCP for high-throughput payment processing.

Sep. 2021 - Apr. 2022 **Senior Software Engineer & Architect**, *EMB Software Engineering*, Remote.

Software consultancy delivering cloud-native backends for data-heavy applications.

- **Repeatable client infrastructure:** Owned end-to-end AWS deployment with Terraform, reused across multiple client projects.
- **Shorter delivery cycles:** Led API-First technical design so teams could build in parallel and integrate with less friction.

Jan. 2019 - Sep. 2021 **Senior Software Engineer**, *Citruslabs (Techstars)*, Remote.

Clinical-trial recruitment platform connecting patients to research.

- **Cut customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day:** Redesigned the MySQL data model so new trials were set up through configuration instead of custom development.
- **Lowered patient recruitment cost:** Built funnel tracking pipelines (1,000+ responses per trial) that exposed a 10% drop-off and drove changes that reduced recruitment cost.
- **70% faster time-to-market:** Built CI/CD workflows with GitHub Actions on AWS.

Feb. 2018 - Sep. 2018 **Lead Software Engineer**, *Higglers*, London.

Very early-stage SaaS platform for event organizers and traders.

- **Wide ownership at a very early stage:** Led the redesign of the architecture and the engineering team, reported directly to the CEO, and designed and built new features.

Oct. 2016 - Feb. 2018 **Software Engineer**, *cloud.IQ (PayPal)*, London.

London startup using AI to help online sellers increase sales.

- **From support to development:** Started in support, learned how clients configure the product, then moved into development and built the proof of concept for the new self-service client portal.
- **MySQL and MongoDB at scale:** Developed against MySQL tables with millions of rows, plus data research for reports and MongoDB work.

Feb. 2015 - Aug. 2016 **Software Engineer**, *Critical Software*, Coimbra.

Mission-critical car rental system (MobiCS) and a safety engineering management application.

- **Payments and international invoicing:** As MobiCS expanded to Latin America and European countries, refactored the payment and invoicing system for international requirements, and built a custom Java tool on short notice so the client could keep charging users during provider onboarding.
- **Java EE 6 and 7, PostgreSQL, 24/7 on-call:** Built features in EJB, JPA/Hibernate, JMS and JBoss applications, wrote SQL and PL/SQL, and covered on-call production support.

Education

2013 - **MSc in Software Engineering**, *Coimbra University*, Coimbra.
Attended

2009 - 2014 **BSc in Computer Science**, *Coimbra University*, Coimbra.

Languages

Portuguese	**Native**	
English	**Professional proficiency**	*Used in daily work communication.*
Spanish & French	**Basic proficiency**	*Able to understand common phrases in professional settings.*

Technical skills

Programming	Python (Django, FastAPI), JavaScript/Typescript (NodeJS, React), Java, PHP, C
Cloud & Data	GCP, AWS, BigQuery, Kafka, Elasticsearch, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform
Databases	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Firestore
CI/CD	Github Actions, CircleCI, Jenkins

Social Skills

Communication	Bridging the gap between complex backend architecture and business metrics.
Leadership	Led and mentored engineering teams, fostering high-scale engineering cultures.

Additional Activities and Interests

IoT problem solver and Arduino enthusiast; home brewing enthusiast.